1. THE VILLAGE

Introduction

Maingal is a small hilly village 24 kms. from Chamba the District Headquarters. Upto four miles, the road runs parallel to Sahu stream. The village can be approached upto sixth mile-stone by a jeep. The onward journey of nine miles is on a dusty bridal path with a gradual ascent right upto the village.

On the way one has to pass Chambi, Gulaira, Jadaira and Shilaghrat villages. At the edge of the road on Jadaira, there is a Government Fruit Nursery comprising of about 2 acres where apple plants are propagated. A nice neglected but pretty little P.W.D. Rest House and a Panchayat-ghar are located in Shilaghrat.

The village is composed of many small hamlets. These are Bhalala, Bhooloo, Galoo, Gandera, Kayada, Maingal, Malog, Manaita, Manait, Manaiti, Ragnal, Dapaytha-got, and Tritha. Only Maingal has a concentration of six houses. The rest of the hamlets have two or one house each. Area within the village boundaries is known as Maingal Mohal. In fact, scattered houses are found in whole of the Shila Valley.

Grounds for Selection

The village is predominently inhabited by Muslim-Gujjars. These have been classified as belonging to Scheduled Tribes in Himachal Pradesh. Though Gujjars are nomadic, but here they own land and houses.

History of the Village

It is generally believed that Gaddi Brahmins were the first settlers in this village. The Muslim-Gujjars penetrated in this area during the last three or four generations. Gradually these managed to acquire landed property and now have become the permanent residents of Maingal. The village elders could not give clue to the past history of the village. Nor could they tell us as to how the village derived its name. Therefore, much reliance has to be placed upon the history of the village as available in the revenue records, This runs as:—

शजरा नसब मालकान बन्दोबस्त कानूनी मुहाल मैंगल नम्बर हदबस्त 250 चक तसकीस पर्वत तेहसील व जिला चम्बा—
1. बुनियाद हसूल हकीमत व तकसीम अव्वलीन जमीन । यह जमीन सबसे पहले सला ब्राह्मण को राजा से इस कारण मिली कि राजा ने हवन के लिये पण्डित बुलवाए । हवन का काम शुरू करने पर पण्डितों ने हवन के लिये आग मंगवाई । इस पर सला ब्राह्मण ने दूसरे पण्डितों को कहा कि हवन में आग खुद बखुद लगनी चाहिये । राजा ने आज्ञा दी कि यदि और पण्डित इस कार्य में असमर्थ हैं तो तुम डालो । सला ने मन्त्रों द्वारा हवन में आग डाल दी । प्रसन्न होकर राजा ने [illegible] दिया—[illegible] हम सब जमीन पर काबिज चले आ रहे हैं—दिगर मालकान ने बाद में [illegible] [illegible] नोतोड़ हासिल की ।

2. [illegible] देह में [illegible] [illegible]—क्योंकि जो हवन इस [illegible] पण्डितों ने किया उसमें आग [illegible] को पड़ी इसलिये जो [illegible] उस ब्राह्मण को मिला वह मंगलवार को मिला—इस वास्ते मंगलवार का बिगड़ते-बिगड़ते मैंगल नाम देह का पड़ गया—

English Version

Genealogical history of the landlords of Maingal, Revenue village No. 250, Tehsil and District Chamba as available in revenue records.

1. Original acquisition, rights and distribution of the land.

First of all the land was donated by the Rajha to a Brahmin, Sala by name. The Rajha sent for some priests to perform a *hawan*.